The two-model shortlist

Local trials | 8 October 2026 | Both options run without an API key

What we checked	Qwen3 4B Instruct 2507 DEFAULT	Fin-R1 ALTERNATIVE
Main use	Balanced interactive workflow	Candidate for reviewing and rewriting claims
Structured responses	7/7 completed and schema-valid	7/7 completed and schema-valid
Idea extraction	Included students; added unprovided features and omitted provenance/constraints	Added twenty audiences and unprovided features; omitted provenance/constraints
Seeded-error critic	Flagged both false claims and the fabricated citation	Flagged both false claims; did not diagnose the fabricated citation
Revision	Improved summary; retained false wording under weaker claim labels	Rewrote the false percentage and profit guarantee as uncertainty
Debate replies	Both obeyed the numbers rule; Pro asserted an unverified competitor limitation	Pro repeated forbidden numbers and an unverified competitor limitation
Fictional cashbook	Correct: closing cash INR 4,600; net change INR -400	Named a formula; did not calculate either requested result
Citation accuracy	Some valid IDs attached to unrelated claims	Some valid IDs attached to unrelated claims
First call	18.47 s	26.02 s
Six later calls	14.43 s median 4.18-34.61 s range	17.35 s median 4.58-38.62 s range

Decision: Keep Qwen as the default. Fin-R1's observed advantage is rewriting unsupported claims. Neither model consistently established correct citation support.

Fair comparison: Same seven independent cases, synthetic fixtures and frozen v1 prompts. Q4_K_M weights; context 4,096; output cap 1,024; temperature 0; seed 42; timeout 180 s. One run per case on an i5-12450H, 16 GB RAM and RTX 3050 Laptop 6 GB. Load and output length varied; timing is not a controlled speed ranking.

Evidence limit: The newer Qwen app workflow completed debates and saving, but retained zero sources or market figures for the Indian textbook example. Fin-R1 was tested on the baseline cases, not that complete app workflow. A model switch does not supply missing market evidence.

Trial records: integration/model_trials/qwen3_4b_instruct.json and fin_r1.json.
The concise Markdown comparison and archived full audit are in the same folder.